

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 4
 ♥ K 10 5 4
 ♦ J 10 9 5 3
 ♣ 10 5

♠ 8 5

♥ J 7 6 2

♦ 8 6

♣ A K Q 4 3



♠ Q 10 9 6 3

♥ Q 9

♦ K 4

♣ J 9 8 7

♠ A K 7 2

♥ A 8 3

♦ A Q 7 2

♣ 6 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

North's ♣ bid was Stayman, but he didn't match ♠s. South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♦ J, East plays ♦ K.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=3 Total = 8

With the ♦ K onside you have 8 tricks, and only need one more. If ♣s split 3-3 you can get 2 extras and make an overtrick. But when you are missing 6 cards they are more likely to be 4-2 than 3-3. Since you only need 4 ♣ tricks you should establish the suit with a duck.

Win the ♦ A and play a small ♣ from each hand.

The defense gets a cheap trick in ♣s but you don't mind because you still have a small ♣ for an entry to dummy. You win whatever they return and take the rest of your winners, including 4 tricks in ♣s!

If you had played the ♣s from the top you would have come up one trick short.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 4
 ♥ K Q 9 5 4
 ♦ J 7 3
 ♣ Q 10 5

♠ 8 5
 ♥ J 10
 ♦ 8 2
 ♣ A K 8 7 6 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 9 6 3
 ♥ 7 6 2
 ♦ K Q 10 5
 ♣ J

♠ A K 7 2
 ♥ A 8 3
 ♦ A 9 6 4
 ♣ 9 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		1NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥5, East plays the ♥2.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

You are very lucky. Apparently West led from ♥ K Q so you won an undeserved ♥ trick. Now, if ♣s split 2-2 you can make 12 tricks! But hold it a minute. If you play dummy's two top ♣s and they **DON'T** split 2-2 you will only win two ♣ tricks and the contract will fail. Instead you should play a small ♣ from dummy right now. The defenders will win the trick easily, but you will win their return and you will still have a ♣ to get to dummy's 6 ♣ winners!

Ducking a ♣ is the only way to make the contract and you might as well do it at the second trick.